



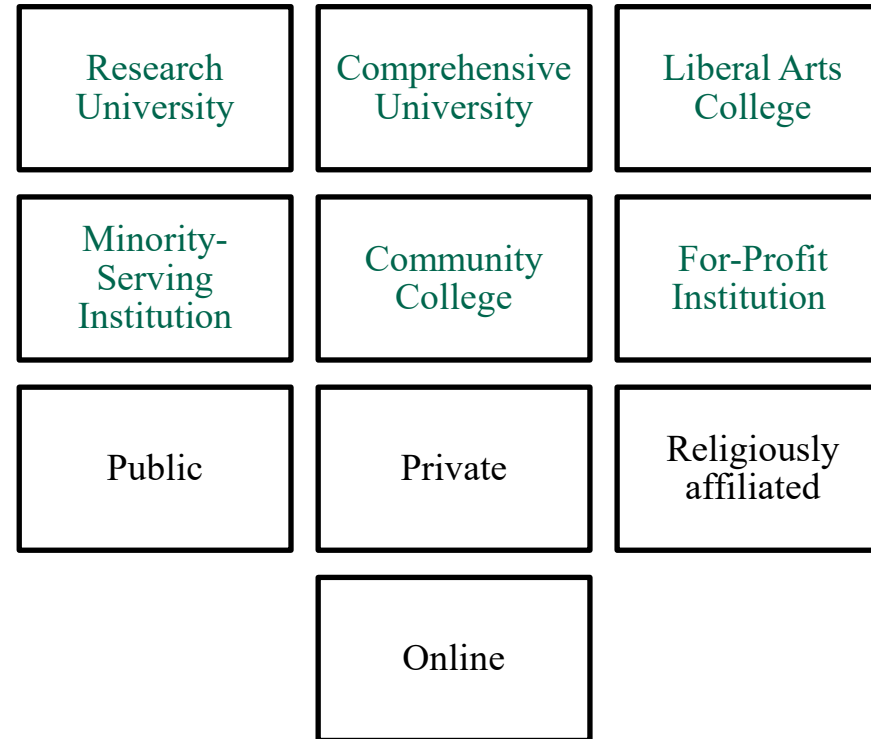
Understanding the University Context – Developing your Teaching Philosophy

Teaching as a Part of Faculty Life

**How many
postsecondary
institutions are
there in the
U.S.?**



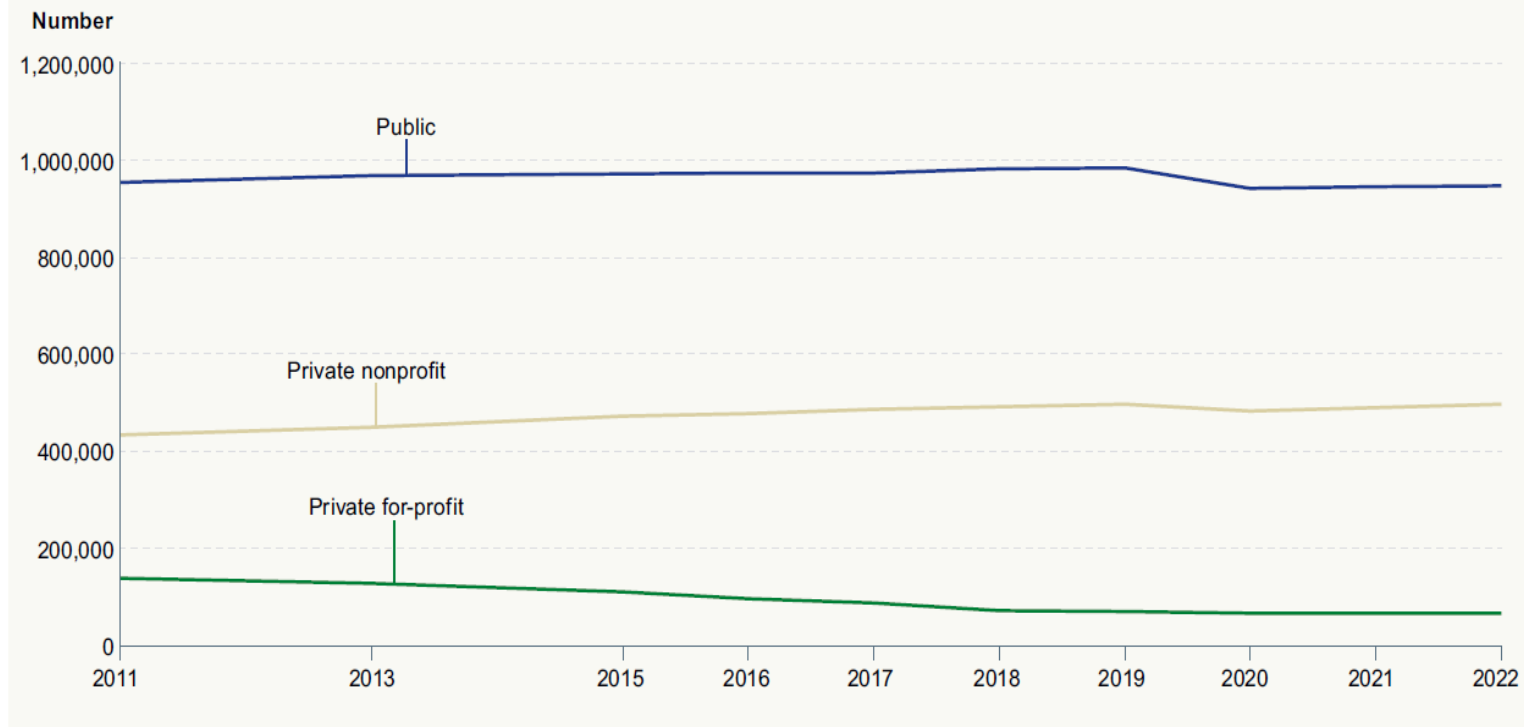
**Close to 4000
postsecondary
institutions in
the U.S.**



What do teaching positions look like now?

FIGURE 2.

Number of faculty in degree-granting postsecondary institutions, by control of institution: Selected years, fall 2011 through fall 2022



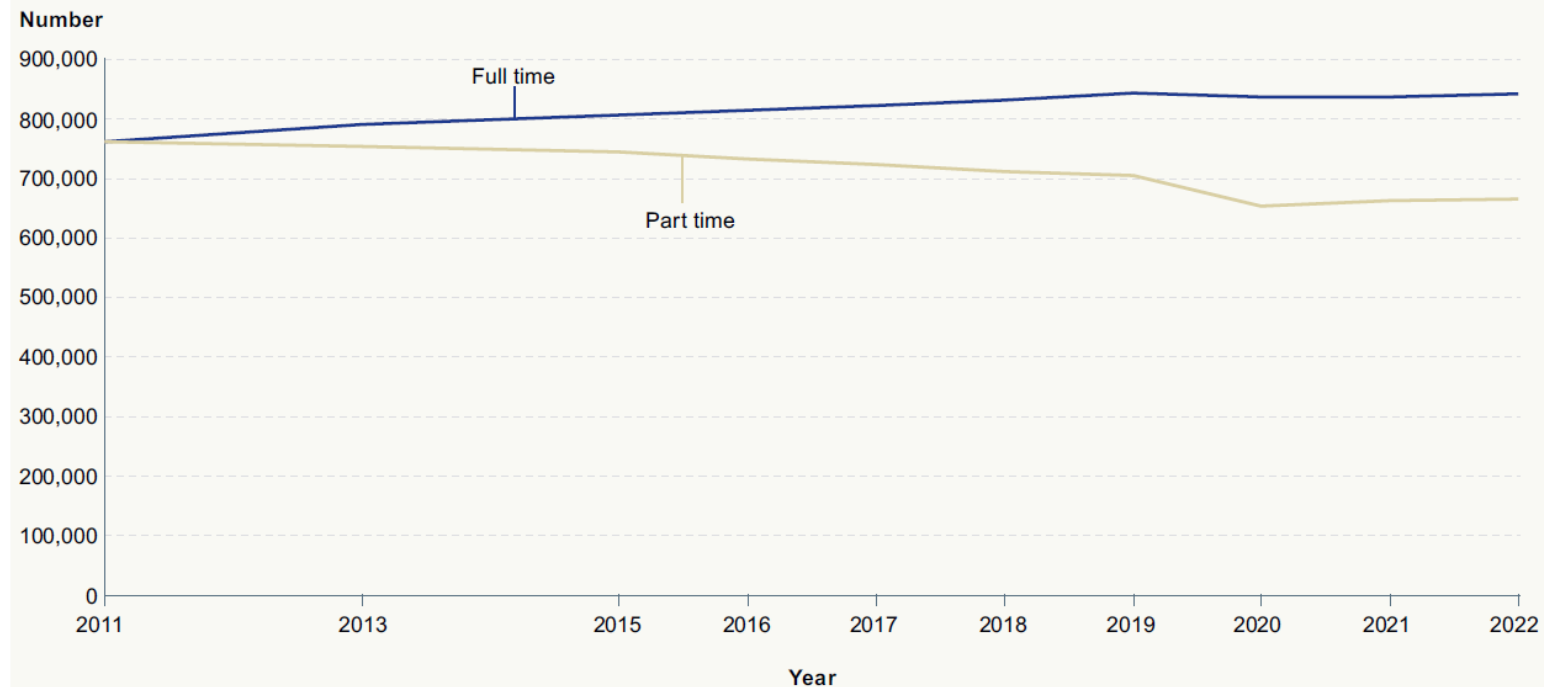
National Center for Education Statistics

What do teaching positions look like now?

Number of Faculty in Postsecondary Institutions

FIGURE 1.

Number of faculty in degree-granting postsecondary institutions, by employment status: Selected years, fall 2011 through fall 2022



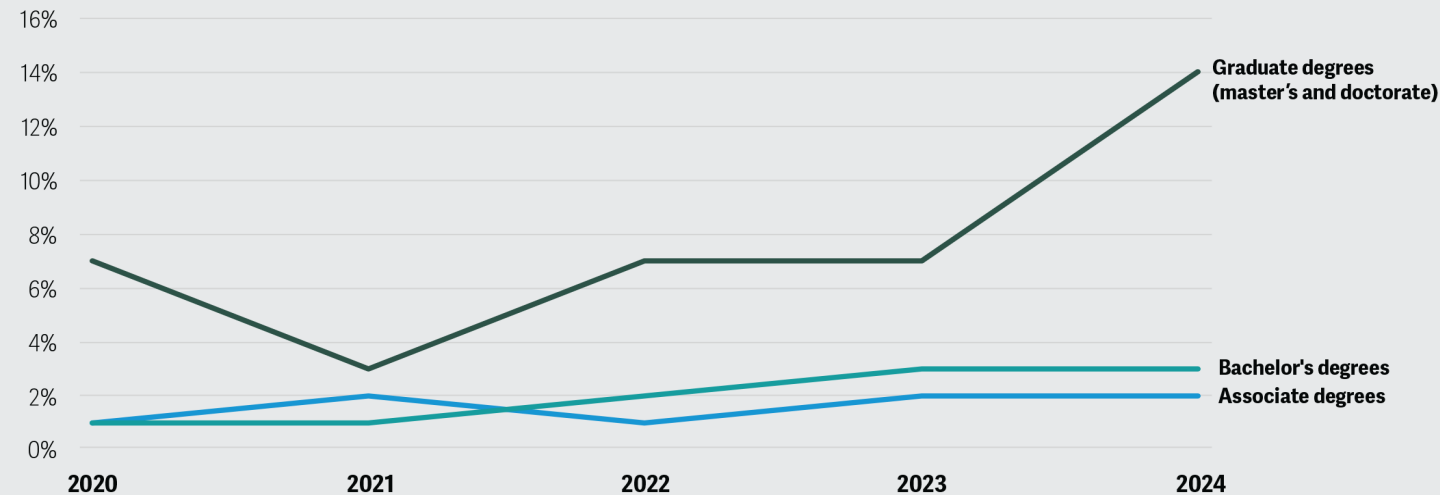
National Center for Education Statistics

Financial constraints

Figure 2

Since 2020, more than 40 colleges have closed in the United States

College closures by types of degree granting



Source: The Hechinger Report, "Counting college closures," December 2024.

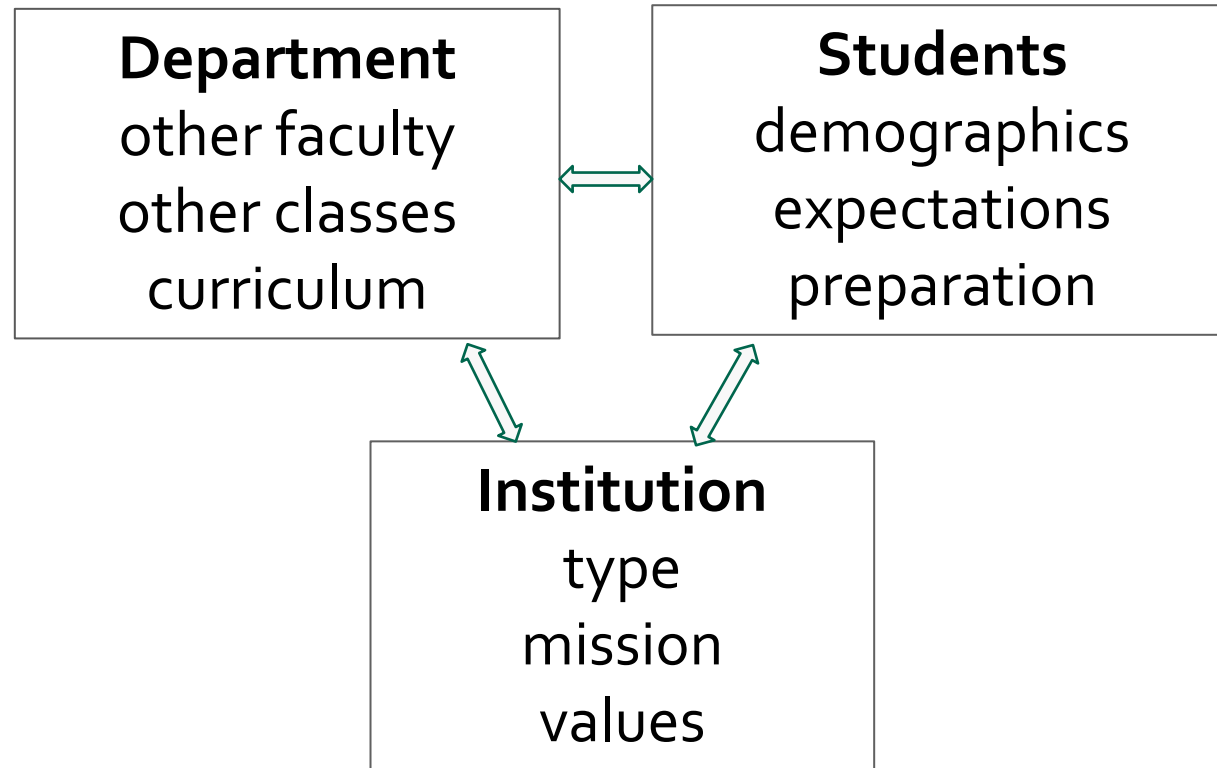
Deloitte Insights | deloitte.com/insights

In 2023, four of the 14 universities currently in the Big Ten Conference reported large operating deficits. Since the beginning of 2024, an average of one college each week has announced it would either close or merge with another institution. At least 20 colleges closed in 2024, and more are set to shut down after the current academic year. *2025 Higher Education Trends*, Deloitte.

**MSU PhDs talk
about teaching
in their new
faculty
positions**

What is your teaching and learning environment?

The teaching and learning environment is larger than a single classroom



TEACHING IS CONTEXT SENSITIVE!

Where?

For whom?

About what?

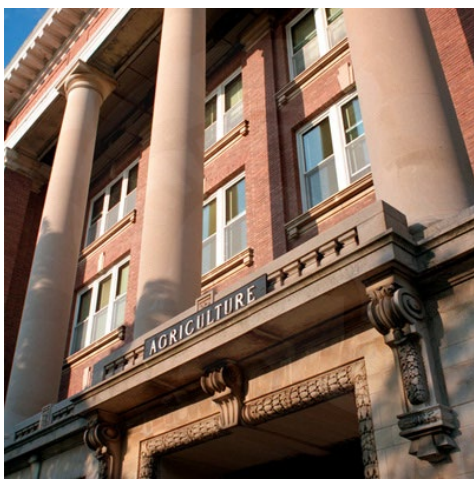


Group Activity

Open the ["Institution Mission and Teaching Statement Document"](#)

In your group

- Focus on assigned institution to discuss (not MSU)
- Based on the institution's mission/vision statement, what does it value in its learning experience for its students?
- Based on the faculty/teaching handbook, how does it evaluate its faculty?
- What surprised you in comparing these 2 statements?
What question did this comparison raise for your group?

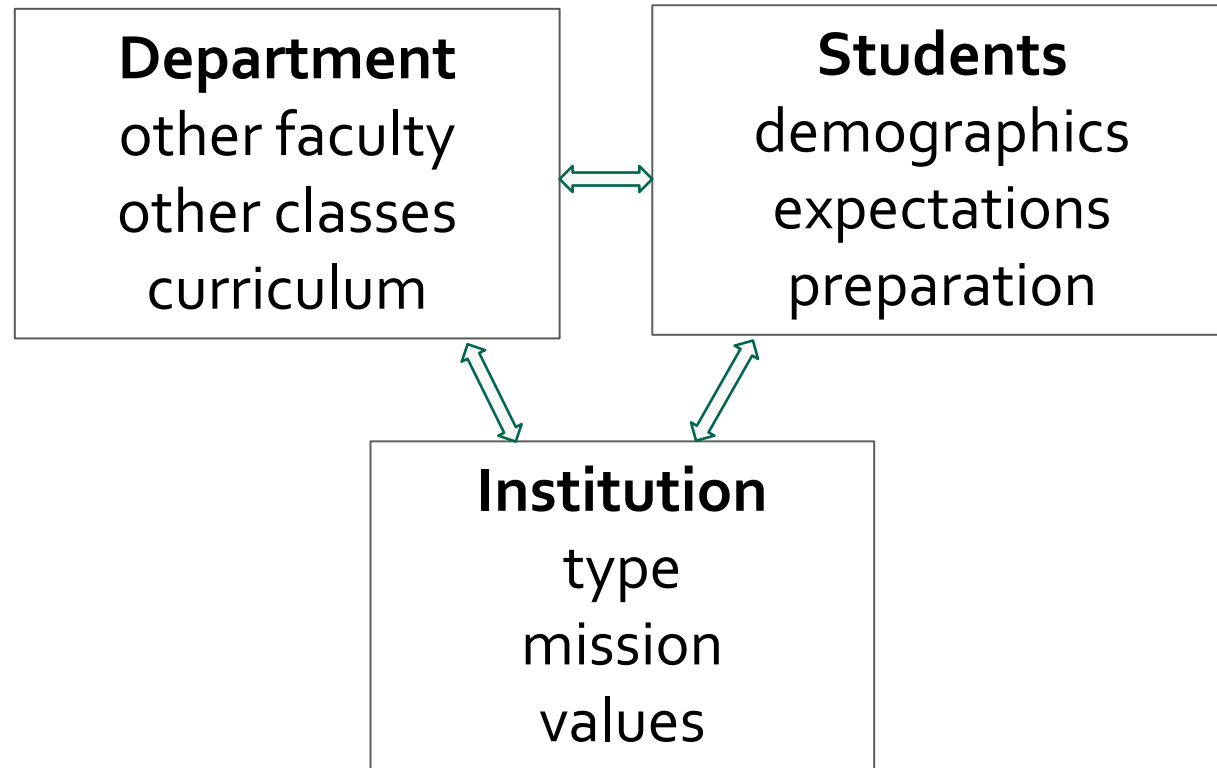


When do these institutional statements matter?

- When you are a graduate student/postdoc preparing for your career
- When you are applying for a job
- When you are a new faculty member

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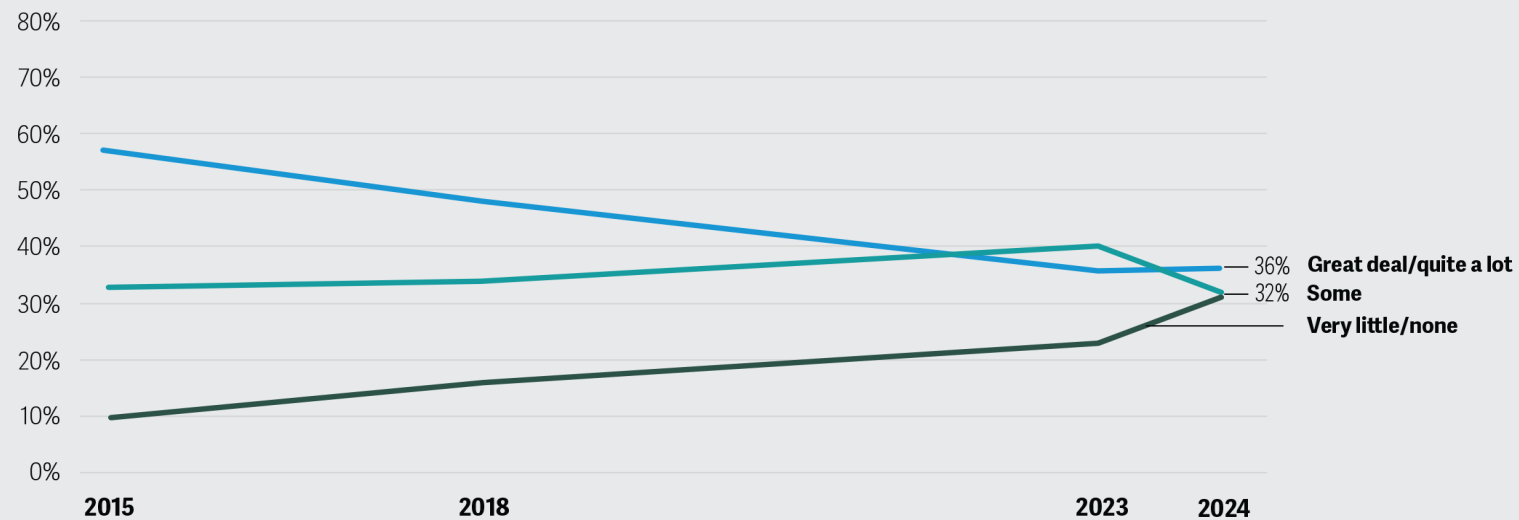
Broader social and demographic trends in higher ed

Changing student expectations

Figure 1

Public confidence in the value of US higher education has declined sharply over the past decade

Confidence in US higher education



Notes: "None" is a volunteered response. No opinion percentages are not shown.

Q: Please tell me how much confidence you have in higher education—a great deal, quite a lot, some, or very little?

Source: Jeffrey M. Jones, "U.S. confidence in higher education now closely divided," *Gallup News*, July 8, 2024.

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Changing faculty roles

“The role that may be subject to the greatest disruption is the role of faculty. Pressure on students to graduate with not only a foundation in thinking and learning but also with career-ready skills on day one is pushing faculty to prepare students differently to succeed in the modern world of work. This is prompting more institutions to incorporate high-impact learning practices—often in the form of hands-on research or integration with corporations and civic or governmental agencies—into their curriculum. The role of faculty is also evolving to serve an increasingly intergenerational study body comprising high school students taking dual enrollment classes, parents juggling kids and work with learning, and retired individuals seeking a next career, on top of the traditional pipeline of 18 to 22-year-olds.”

How do you characterize your teaching style and approaches?

- How do they match institutional expectations?
- How do they match students' expectations?
- How do they respond to the changing landscape of higher education?

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